DocuMind AI

How to use the project: a step-by-step guide

What it does. You upload PDF documents, then ask questions about them in plain language. DocuMind AI answers from your own documents and shows the **document name and page** each answer came from, so you can check it yourself.

1. What you need running

The project has four parts. All of them must be running at the same time:

Part	What it is	Address
MySQL	The database (comes with XAMPP) that stores accounts, documents and chats	port 3306
Ollama	The local AI that writes the answers. It starts by itself with Windows.	port 11434
Backend	The server that reads PDFs and finds answers	http://127.0.0.1:8000
Website	The pages you click on	http://localhost:5173

2. Start it (every time you want to use the project)

Step 1: Start MySQL

Open the **XAMPP Control Panel** and click **Start** next to **MySQL**. Wait until its name turns green. Also check that **Ollama** is running: look for its small llama icon in the system tray (bottom right of the screen). If it is missing, open **Ollama** from the Start menu.

Step 2: Start the backend

Open a terminal (PowerShell) and run these two lines:

```
cd "D:\Rosh-websites\DocuMind AI\backend"
.\run.bat
```

Leave this window open. It is ready when you see `Application startup complete`. You can also check http://127.0.0.1:8000/health in your browser: it should show `"status":"ok"`.

Step 3: Start the website

Open a **second** terminal and run:

```
cd "D:\Rosh-websites\DocuMind AI\frontend"
npm run dev
```

Leave this window open too. Then open **http://localhost:5173** in your browser (Chrome is recommended).

3. Create an account or log in

Use the ready-made demo account

> **Email:** `demo@example.com`
> **Password:** `DocuMind2026`

Click **Log In** at the top right, type these in, and press **Log In**. You land on your Dashboard.

Or register your own account

1. Click **Get Started** (or go to http://localhost:5173/register).
2. Enter your **name**, an **email** (any email works, nothing is ever sent to it) and a **password**.
3. The password needs **at least 8 characters, with a letter and a number**. Type it twice and click **Create account**.

You stay logged in for 30 minutes. After that you are asked to log in again. Use the menu at the top right (your name) → **Log out** to leave at any time.

4. Upload a PDF

1. In the left menu click **My Documents**.
2. Drag a PDF onto the dashed box, or click **Choose files**. Up to 25 MB per file; several files at once are fine.
3. Watch the status next to the file. It updates by itself:
   Processing (the PDF is being read and indexed) → **Ready** (you can ask questions) or **Failed**.

> **Use PDFs with real text** (reports, manuals, policies, e-books, exported documents). A PDF that is only scanned pictures of pages has no text, so it shows **Failed** with the reason "OCR is not supported yet". The very first upload takes a little longer because the AI model loads once.

Click the ⋮ menu on a file to **View details**, **Retry processing** (for failed files) or **Delete**. Click a file name to open its details page, where **Open PDF** shows the original file. You can search by file name and filter by status above the list.

5. Ask questions

1. Click **AI Assistant** in the left menu.
2. Choose where to search with the box at the top right: **All my documents** (default) or tick specific files.
3. Type your question and press **Enter** (use **Shift+Enter** for a new line) or click **Send**. Click one of the example questions if you just want to try it.
4. Read the answer. Under it, **Sources** lists the document and **page number** with a short excerpt. Click a source to open that PDF.
5. Click **Copy answer** to copy the text. Keep asking: follow-up questions stay in the same conversation.

If it says "I couldn't find enough evidence in your documents": that is deliberate. The documents do not contain a clear answer, so the assistant does not guess. Try rewording the question or select the right document.

About the AI: answers are written by a small **AI model running on your own computer** (qwen2.5 3B through Ollama). It needs no internet or API key, but it is slow and less accurate than the big online AIs: expect **10 to 60 seconds** per answer, and always check the cited page, especially for summaries and dates. Sources are verified: a citation is only shown if it points to a passage that was really found in your document.

6. The other pages

Page	What you can do
Dashboard	Totals of your documents (ready / processing / failed), recent uploads, conversations and activity, with quick buttons to upload or ask
Chat History	Find old conversations by title, open them, **rename** (pencil) or **delete** (bin, asks to confirm)
Analytics	Charts of uploads and questions over the last 30 days and how your documents were processed (each chart has a data table underneath)
Settings	Change your name, see account information, upload limits and how your data is handled, and log out

7. Stop everything

1. In the backend window and the website window press **Ctrl + C**, then close them.
2. In the XAMPP Control Panel click **Stop** next to MySQL.

Your accounts, documents and chats are saved. They are still there next time you start.

8. Optional: use a stronger online AI

For faster and more accurate answers you can switch from the local AI to an online one (this needs your own account and may cost money):

1. Get an API key from your AI provider (for example Anthropic or OpenAI).
2. Open `D:\Rosh-websites\DocuMind AI\backend\.env` in Notepad and change these lines (use your own values):

   ```
   LLM_PROVIDER=anthropic
   LLM_API_KEY=your-secret-key-here
   LLM_MODEL=the-model-name-from-your-provider
   ```

   For an OpenAI-style provider use `LLM_PROVIDER=openai`.
3. Save the file, stop the backend (Ctrl + C) and start it again with `.\run.bat`.

Never share the `.env` file or post your key anywhere. If the key or model name is missing or wrong, the assistant shows a clear error instead of a made-up answer.

9. If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
"We could not reach the DocuMind server"	The backend is not running. Do step 2 of section 2 again. Check http://127.0.0.1:8000/health.
Backend shows a database error, or /health says `unreachable`	MySQL is not started. Click **Start** next to MySQL in XAMPP, then restart the backend.
`.\run.bat` says the port is already in use	The backend is already running somewhere. Use it as it is, or close the other window first.
The website page does not open at localhost:5173	The website is not running. Do step 3 of section 2 again.
"Invalid email or password"	Check spelling. Passwords are case-sensitive. Or register a new account.
"Your session has ended"	Normal after 30 minutes. Log in again.
A document shows **Failed**	Read the reason under its name. Scanned PDFs cannot be used. For other reasons click **Retry processing** in the ⋮ menu.
A document stays on **Processing** for a long time	If the backend window was closed or restarted while it was processing, delete the file and upload it again.
"The AI provider could not be reached" when you ask a question	Ollama is not running. Open **Ollama** from the Start menu (the llama icon appears in the system tray) and ask again.
An answer takes a long time	Normal for the local AI on this computer: the first question after a pause also loads the model. Wait up to a minute or two. Close heavy programs to speed it up.
The assistant says to upload a PDF first	You have no document with status **Ready** yet. Upload one in My Documents.

10. Handy facts

- Project folder: `D:\Rosh-websites\DocuMind AI` (website in `frontend`, server in `backend`).
- Uploaded PDFs and the search index are stored in `C:\Users\Jidnyasa\documind-data`.
- Your accounts, documents list and chats are stored in the XAMPP database `documind_ai` (view it in phpMyAdmin).
- Technical details for developers: `backend\README.md` and `frontend\README.md`.
- The demo account lives only on this computer. Change its password or register your own account for real use.